
The website's hosting: stay on Vercel, or move it to Render?

Whether to move www.aajoohomes.com off Vercel and onto Render — what is live on each today, what the move actually takes, what it costs, what it does to speed, and why the current Vercel plan is the item that cannot wait.

Aajoo Homes — website hosting decision

Prepared 27 September 2026 by the Zyphex Tech development team · revised the same day

Read from the live Vercel and Render dashboards and both providers' published pricing; the port has since been built and tested against the live site

1. The question, and the short answer

The proposal on the table is to move `www.aajoohomes.com` off Vercel and onto the Render service that already runs the API, so that everything sits with one provider and the Vercel bill goes away.

It is a sound move, and it should not be made this month. Three findings shape that answer, and the third one changes the question entirely:

- 1. **The move is a software port, not a hosting change.** The website is not a folder of files. A piece of server-side code rewrites every page's SEO information before the page loads, and Render's free static hosting cannot run that code. Moving means rebuilding that piece inside the API. Two to three working days, and it touches the one layer that Google, WhatsApp link previews and an App Store reviewer all depend on.
- 2. **It will not make the site faster.** It saves money and removes a vendor. Anyone presenting it as a speed improvement is mistaken — the honest expectation is "the same, with one part slightly better and one part slightly worse". Section 6 sets out both sides.
- 3. **The current Vercel plan does not permit this website to exist on it.** Vercel's free "Hobby" plan is for non-commercial personal use. Aajoo Homes matches **three** of the five examples Vercel gives for prohibited commercial use. This is not a future risk to manage; it is today's status, and the published remedy is that Vercel pauses the deployment.

The recommendation is therefore in two steps: put Vercel on a paid plan now to end the licensing exposure, which takes minutes and no engineering, and do the Render move in the quiet fortnight after go-live, then close the Vercel subscription. The bridging cost is roughly **\$40–60 (₹3,500–5,300) in total**.

2. What is live today — read from both dashboards on 27 September 2026

On Vercel

Account	<code>nameeshpatiyal100's projects</code> , Hobby (free)
Live project	<code>aajao-admin-web-s-iite-epy6</code> — serves <code>www.aajoohomes.com</code> ; the bare <code>aajoohomes.com</code> redirects to it
Built from	<code>nameeshPatiyal100/Aajao-Admin-WebSIite</code> , connected 23 August 2025; every push to the main branch deploys automatically
Framework	Vite, with no custom build settings at all
Configuration	Two environment variables , both production-only: <code>VITE_API_BASE_URL</code> and <code>VITE_GOOGLE_MAPS_KEY</code>
Databases / file storage on Vercel	None
Third-party integrations	One — Entri Connect, a domain-setup helper

Certificates	Two, renewing automatically in late November 2026
Also hosted here	The domain's entire DNS zone — 17 records , ten of which carry email

Usage over the last thirty days, against the free plan's ceilings — nothing is under any pressure:

Meter	Used	Included
Function CPU time	34m 42s	4 hours
Function invocations	10,000	1,000,000
Edge requests	38,000	1,000,000
Data transfer	2.57 GB	100 GB
Build storage	403 MB	10 GB

Two housekeeping items surfaced while reading this:

- A **second, abandoned Vercel project** (`aajao-frontend-vercel`) is still serving a build from 17 August. It has no code repository connected, no configuration, and no domain. It should be deleted.
- **Neither environment variable is set for preview builds.** Every pull-request preview is therefore built with no API address and no Maps key baked in, which means a preview link is not a valid way to check a fix. A five-minute change.

On Render

Workspace plan	Pro , billed to AAJOO HOMES PRIVATE LIMITED
Live API service	<code>aajoo-api-singapore</code> — Singapore region, 1 CPU / 2 GB, \$25 per month
Serving	<code>api.aajoohomes.com</code> , deploying automatically from <code>nameeshPatiyal100/aajaoBackend</code>
Load over the past 48 hours	CPU close to 1%. Memory under 10%. One instance.
Custom domains	1 used of 15 included
Bandwidth	898 MB used of 25 GB included
Charges this month	\$9.93 to date, projected \$16.15 for September — a part month, because the Singapore service is only days old

The Singapore machine is almost entirely idle, and the plan already includes fourteen unused custom domains and 24 GB of unused monthly bandwidth. This is the single strongest fact in favour of the move: the capacity to serve the website has already been bought and is sitting unused.

Two old services are still running in Oregon. `aaajaodev` and `aaजूHomes` are both live, the second untouched for two years. They cost nothing — they are on free instances — but `aaajaodev` still answers requests and still redeploys on every backend commit, which makes it a stale copy of the API that could be reached by mistake. These should be suspended. It is unrelated to the decision in this document and can be done this week.

3. The licensing problem, which is the real reason to act

Vercel's Hobby plan is free because it is not for businesses. Vercel's fair use guidelines restrict Hobby accounts to non-commercial personal use, and define commercial use as any deployment serving the financial gain of anyone involved in any part of producing the project — explicitly including a paid consultant writing the code.

Vercel lists five examples. **Aajoo Homes matches three of them:**

Vercel's example	Aajoo Homes
Requesting or processing payment from visitors of the site	The Razorpay checkout
Advertising the sale of a product or service	Property listings and bookings
Receiving payment to create, update, or host the site	Zyphex Tech is engaged to build it

There is no interpretation under which this is a personal project. The site is not currently over any usage limit, so nothing has been flagged — but the published remedy for a policy breach is that Vercel pauses the account or the deployment, and a pause takes `www.aaजूhomes.com` offline without notice.

Reading this changed our recommendation. Before it, the choice was between \$0 and a two-to-three-day migration, and waiting looked free. It is not free — staying on Hobby is carrying an outage risk that has nothing to do with traffic and cannot be planned around.

There is a second, quieter consequence. The Hobby plan has no team collaboration, so the entire production website sits inside one personal account with no second owner and no way to grant anyone defined access. A paid plan fixes that as a side effect.

4. The four options

	Cost	Engineering	Verdict
A. Stay on Hobby	\$0	none	Not viable. Prohibited use of the plan; the remedy is a pause
B. Vercel Pro	\$20/mo ≈ ₹1,780	none	Viable and instant. Also buys team seats, spend controls and a day of logs instead of an hour
C. A second Render web service	\$7/mo ≈ ₹620	2–3 days	The destination. Custom domains and bandwidth are already paid for on the workspace; only the instance is new

	Cost	Engineering	Verdict
D. Fold into the existing API service	\$0 extra	2–3 days	Not available in practice — see below

Why D is not the free lunch it appears to be. The API service is built from a Dockerfile whose build context is the *backend* repository, and the website lives in a different one. Sharing them means either a Git submodule or a credentialed clone inside the Docker build — and from then on every website change needs a backend commit to point at it. That couples two codebases that have no reason to be coupled, and slows down the faster-moving one, to save \$7 a month.

An earlier draft of this document recommended D at **\$0 extra**. Building the port established that it does not work cleanly, so the figure has been corrected rather than left flattering.

A further option does not exist at all, though it looks like it should. Render's static site hosting is genuinely free and would be the obvious home for a website — but Render's own documentation is explicit that a static site cannot run server-side code. Our SEO layer is server-side code. Choosing it would mean silently giving up SEO Phase 1, which was commissioned and delivered. That is covered next.

5. What moving actually takes

The website is a Vite application, which does produce a folder of static files. If that were all, this would be a half-day job.

It is not all. Every page request is currently routed through a piece of server-side code (`api/seo-render.ts` and a supporting file, about 970 lines between them). It asks the API what that specific URL's title, description and preview image should be, and rewrites the page's `<head>` before the browser renders anything. That is SEO Phase 1.

Without it, every page ships the same generic information. Around 29,000 listings would share one title and one preview image, and every link pasted into WhatsApp would preview as the home page.

So the work is:

Task	
1	Rebuild the SEO renderer as a route inside the API service. Both files already use web-standard code rather than Vercel-specific code, so the logic transfers; it is the wiring that is new
2	Replace its network call to the API with a direct internal call — this is where the one genuine speed gain comes from
3	Serve the website's files ahead of the renderer: a real file wins, everything else gets rendered
4	Move the website build into the deployment, with both environment variables present at build time — Vite writes them permanently into the files it produces, so setting them afterwards does nothing
5	Delete the two Vercel-specific configuration files, which exist only to work around Vercel behaviour
6	Automated tests covering each of the above

Then, before anything is pointed at it: deploy to Render's own address while nothing uses it, and check a dozen real URLs with a search-engine crawler — home page, a listing, FAQ, About, the account-deletion page, a blog post, a missing page — confirming each returns the correct status **and** the correct title. A page can look perfect in a browser and still tell Google it does not exist; that specific fault has occurred on this project before.

Then the switch itself is one DNS record, and reversing it is the same record. The Vercel project stays deployable for 48 hours so that rollback stays real.

One known hazard, named so it cannot be stumbled into. The SEO renderer reads the page shell over the network. If that request is allowed to route back into the renderer, the site fails with an infinite loop. This has taken this site down once before. The port reads the shell directly from disk, which removes the possibility rather than guarding against it.

6. What changes for speed

Today the SEO renderer runs on Vercel's edge network, at a location near the visitor — Mumbai, for most Indian traffic — and makes one call to Singapore for the page's data. After the move, everything is served from Singapore.

Effect	
Page HTML	Slightly better. The SEO lookup stops being a network round trip and becomes an internal call
Images, scripts, styling	Slightly worse. A 3.1 MB bundle travels from Singapore rather than from a Mumbai edge location

The second effect is real and measurable, and there is a specific fix: Render's **Edge Caching**, which serves static files from locations near the visitor. It was switched off; it was **turned on for the API service on 27 September** using the "Common static files" profile, which caches images, scripts and stylesheets but deliberately **not** HTML or JSON — caching per-visitor JSON at an edge would be a data-protection problem, not an optimisation. The new web service will need the same setting turned on after its first deploy, and we would measure load times from India before and after rather than assume.

Net expectation: **broadly unchanged**, provided edge caching is enabled. We would rather say that plainly now than present a saving as a performance win.

7. What it costs, side by side

Converted at roughly ₹89 to the dollar. Vercel prices exclude GST.

	Now	Year 1	Each year after
A. Hobby	\$0	\$0	\$0 — but prohibited, and pausable without notice
B. Vercel Pro	\$20/mo	\$240 ≈ ₹21,400	\$240 ≈ ₹21,400

	Now	Year 1	Each year after
C. A second Render service	\$7/mo	\$84 ≈ ₹7,500	\$84 ≈ ₹7,500
D. Fold into the API service	\$0	\$0	\$0 — but couples the two codebases; not recommended

The saving from moving is about **\$156 (₹13,900) a year** — \$20 a month on Vercel against \$7 on Render. It is worth being clear-eyed about that figure: it is real and it recurs, but it is smaller than two to three days of engineering time in the first year. The move pays for itself from year two onward.

Both services sit in Singapore, so the website's call to the API is a same-region hop of about a millisecond. That is why running them as two services costs almost nothing in speed.

The stronger arguments for moving are not financial:

- One provider, one dashboard, one bill, one place where both the website and the API live.
- One fewer account whose terms are currently being breached.
- Capacity already purchased and sitting at 1% utilisation.

And the strongest argument against moving *right now* is sequencing. Ahead of it are Razorpay live activation, the host listing wizard fault, and getting an iOS build onto TestFlight. This work touches the layer that search engines, shared links and app-store reviewers all see, and a break in that layer is invisible for days and expensive to discover late.

8. The recommendation

Move the website to Render — after go-live, not during it.

When	Step	Who	Cost
This week	Upgrade Vercel to Pro. Ends the licensing exposure immediately, requires no engineering, and can be cancelled any month	Client — billing details	\$20/mo
This week Done 27 Sep	Both old Oregon services suspended; Edge Caching enabled on the API service	Zyphex	\$0
After go-live Done 27 Sep	The port is built and tested. It answers with the same status and the same page titles as the live site on every URL checked, including the 404s	Zyphex	—
This week	Add the two environment variables to Vercel preview builds; delete the abandoned Vercel project	Zyphex	\$0
After go-live	Deploy the new service and verify it on Render's own address, with no domain pointed at it	Zyphex	half a day
Then	Switch one DNS record; keep Vercel deployable for 48 hours	both	\$0
48 hours later	Turn off the Vercel project and cancel the Pro subscription	Client	back to \$0

Total bridging cost, assuming two to three months on Pro: **\$40–60 (₹3,500–5,300)**. Vercel also offers a Pro trial, which may reduce this further — worth checking at the point of upgrading.

What we are explicitly not recommending: starting the migration this month to avoid two months of subscription. Saving \$40 by putting a high-consequence change onto the go-live critical path is a poor trade.

One thing that should not move with it

The domain's DNS — all 17 records — currently lives at Vercel. It is tempting to move it at the same time so that nothing is left behind.

Render does not offer DNS hosting at all, so there is no "move it to Render" option; the realistic destinations are the domain registrar or Cloudflare. More importantly, ten of those records carry email, and every one-time passcode on this platform is sent by email — signup, sign-in, password reset. A mistake there locks everyone out of the site and the apps, and looks exactly like a software fault.

If the zone is moved at all, it should be a separate change made after the website move has been stable for two days — never in the same window, or a mail failure has two possible causes and no way to tell them apart. A full record inventory and a safe procedure are documented separately and are ready when that decision is taken.

9. Decisions needed from you

1. **Approve the Vercel Pro upgrade** — \$20/month, cancellable, ends the licensing exposure this week. This is the only item that cannot wait.
 2. **Confirm the migration is wanted** at roughly two to three days of engineering, scheduled for after go-live, saving about ₹13,900 a year thereafter. **The port itself is already built and tested** (27 September); what remains is the deployment and the cutover.
 3. **Confirm SEO Phase 1 behaviour must be preserved** through the move. We assume yes; it was commissioned and delivered, and it is the reason the cheaper static-hosting route is not available.
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Prices read from Vercel's and Render's published documentation and from both live dashboards on 27 September 2026. Usage figures are the last thirty days as reported by each provider. The Vercel plan restrictions quoted are from Vercel's own fair use guidelines.